CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Communicate Like a CEO Course Handbook

"Speak with the clarity, calm and authority of the top 1%."



Executive Leadership & Communication Track | 6 Weeks | All Levels Self-Paced Study Edition

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Course Foreword



Most people believe great communicators are born that way. They are not. The calm executive who answers a tough question in one clean sentence spent years building that skill on purpose. You can build it faster, because you now have a map.

This book is short on theory and long on practice. Every chapter ends with something to do out loud, on camera, or in front of a person. Reading it will teach you nothing. Doing the drills will change how people treat you.

THE PRACTITIONER PROMISE

By the last page you will structure your thoughts under pressure, hold a room, and say hard things without losing respect, whether you are pitching an investor or answering a question in class.

A warning: you will feel awkward the first few times. That awkwardness is the sound of a skill being installed. Push through it and, within weeks, people start describing you with a word you may never have heard about yourself before, 'impressive'.

Published by CHRISCO Digital Academy under CHRISCO Youth Aflame (*CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches*), this 8-module workbook equips youth and emerging leaders with practical, ethical, income-ready skills. Complete every chapter drill in a dedicated workbook and reach our mentorship desk anytime at chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.



Key Outcomes

01

Executive presence starts in your head: Presence is self-control made visible.

02

Body language and the power of the pause: First impressions are physical, not verbal.

03

Persuade without pressure: Start from their goal, not your ask.

04

Own the camera and the online room: Rehearse out loud and on camera, not in your head.

Across 6 Weeks of structured practice, learners progress from core principles to real-world execution. Every module pairs concise frameworks with an immediate hands-on drill so knowledge turns into demonstrable competence.

Graduates finish with a tangible portfolio deliverable in Communicate Like a CEO, ready to serve clients, employers, ministries, and communities with excellence and integrity.

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01
Foundations & Core Mindset

Module 1: Executive presence starts in your head | Module 2: Say less, mean more



1.1 Executive presence starts in your head

Presence is not volume or expensive clothes. It is the visible signal that you are in control of yourself. Before you fix your words, you fix the story you tell yourself in the ten seconds before you speak. Nervous people rehearse the disaster: 'What if I forget, what if they laugh.' Leaders rehearse the outcome: 'I know this. I am here to help them understand it.'

Your body follows your mind, but the reverse is also true. Stand with both feet planted, shoulders down, breathe out slowly before your first word. That single slow exhale drops your voice half a tone and tells your nervous system there is no lion in the room. Do it every time until it is automatic.

Real-World Example: Before a big pitch, a founder I mentored used to shake. We changed one thing: three slow breaths and the sentence 'I am the most prepared person in this room.' Same slides, same voice, but investors started leaning in. Nothing changed except what she believed as she walked in.

Hands-On Practice: Record a 60-second phone video introducing yourself and what you do. Watch it once. Note one thing your body does when nervous (touching your face, looking down, rushing). Record it again, fixing only that one thing.

Core Takeaways: Presence is self-control made visible. • One slow exhale before you speak lowers your voice and your fear. • Rehearse the outcome, not the disaster.

1.2 Say less, mean more

The fastest way to sound senior is to cut words. Juniors explain everything; leaders lead with the conclusion, then support it. This is called answering first. If your boss asks 'Will we finish by Friday?' do not narrate the whole week. Say: 'Yes, two tasks remain and both are on track.' Headline first, detail on request.

Practise the one-breath rule: your main point should fit in a single breath. If you run out of air before your point lands, it is too long. Write your key message as one sentence before any important conversation. If you cannot, you are not ready to speak yet, you are still thinking out loud.

01

Practitioner Case

Two people ask for a raise. The first talks for four minutes about effort and loyalty. The second says: 'I have taken on the reports work that used to need two people. I would like my pay to reflect that.' One breath, one clear ask. Guess who gets taken seriously.

02

Action Drill

Take something you explained recently in a long message. Rewrite it as one sentence that leads with the conclusion. Send that version next time.

03

Key Standard

Answer first, explain second. If your point does not fit one breath, it is not ready. Clarity reads as confidence.



02
Core Frameworks & Strategy

Module 3: Body language and the power of the pause | Module 4: Structure any talk in three moves

2.1 Body language and the power of the pause

People decide how to feel about you before they process your words. Eye contact says 'I am not afraid of you.' An open chest and steady hands say 'I belong here.' You do not need to perform power poses; you need to stop the small habits that leak fear, fidgeting, filler words, and the nervous laugh at the end of your own sentences.

Your most powerful tool is silence. When you finish a point, stop. Do not fill the gap with 'so, yeah, that is basically it.' A confident pause forces attention and signals that you meant what you said. Amateurs fear silence; professionals use it as punctuation.

Core Principle

First impressions are physical, not verbal.

Field Case Study

In interviews, the strongest candidates answer, then go quiet. The weak ones keep talking to fill the pause and undo their good answer. The pause is not empty, it is you holding the frame.

Applied Exercise

In your next three conversations, when you finish a sentence, count 'one-two' silently before adding anything. Notice how people lean in to fill the space instead of you.

Mastery Check

Kill filler words, they leak fear. • Silence after a point is strength, not a mistake.

2.2 Three-Step Execution Rhythm

Step 1	Prepare & Frame First impressions are physical, not verbal.	Practice Focus Audit your current approach before acting.
Step 2	Execute Deliberately Kill filler words, they leak fear.	Practice Focus Focus on clarity, calm pace, and measurable value.
Step 3	Review & Refine Silence after a point is strength, not a mistake.	Practice Focus Record outcomes and sharpen one habit per rep.

2.3 Structure any talk in three moves

Whether you have thirty seconds or thirty minutes, a strong message has the same skeleton: the point, the proof, the ask. Point, what you want them to know. Proof, one story, number, or example that makes it real. Ask, what you want them to do next. Most people give proof with no point and no ask, so nothing happens.

This structure works for a WhatsApp voice note, a class presentation, or a funding pitch. It removes rambling because you always know which of the three moves you are in. When you feel lost mid-sentence, ask yourself: point, proof, or ask?, and jump to the next one.

01

Every message = Point, Proof, Ask.

02

One piece of proof beats five weak ones.

03

No ask means no result.

2.4 Real-World Case & Lab Assignment

Practitioner Case Study

Pitch in three moves: 'We help boda riders in Jinja earn more (point). In our pilot, ten riders raised their weekly income by a third (proof). I am asking for equipment to reach a hundred more (ask).' Twelve seconds. Fundable.

Your Practical Assignment

Pick a topic you care about. Write three lines only: Point, Proof, Ask. Deliver it out loud in under 30 seconds. Trim until it flows.

CHRISCO Youth Aflame Study Principle: "Every message = Point, Proof, Ask. Consistent execution in small daily assignments builds authority that cannot be faked."



03
Execution & Applied Mastery

Module 5: Persuade without pressure | Module 6: Handle hard conversations and feedback

3.1 Persuade without pressure

Persuasion is not tricking people; it is helping them see why your idea serves what they already want. Start from their world, not yours. Before you propose anything, name their goal or fear out loud: 'You want this delivered without surprises, right?' When people feel understood, their resistance drops and they can actually hear you.

Then bridge from their goal to your idea using the word 'so': 'You want it done right the first time, so I suggest we test with five users before we launch.' Facts inform, but stories move. Wrap your key point in a 20-second real example and it will be remembered long after the meeting ends.



Case: A teacher wanted tablets for her class. She did not lead with the cost. She said: 'You care about pass rates. Here is a girl who could not read last term; with practice on one shared tablet, she now can.' The story sold the tablets.

Action Drill: Think of something you want someone to agree to. Write the first sentence starting with THEIR goal, not yours. Practise saying it before you make the request.

3.2 Handle hard conversations and feedback

Leaders are trusted because they can say uncomfortable things cleanly. The formula is simple: be soft on the person, hard on the problem. Describe the behaviour, not the character. 'The report was late twice this week' is workable. 'You are lazy' starts a war. Facts first, feelings owned by you, then a clear request.

When you receive criticism, do not defend instantly. Breathe, say 'thank you, let me think about that,' and separate the useful 10% from the delivery. The ability to take feedback without collapsing or attacking is one of the rarest and most valuable executive skills there is.



Case: Instead of 'you never listen', try: 'When I was interrupted in the meeting, I felt my point was lost. Next time, can I finish before we respond?' Same message, but one keeps the relationship and gets the result.

Action Drill: Write one difficult thing you need to say to someone. Rewrite it in three parts: the fact, how it affected you, and one clear request. Say it within the week.



04
Scaling, Capstone & Excellence

Module 7: Own the camera and the online room | Module 8: Your CEO-level talk

4.1 Own the camera and the online room

Most opportunities now begin on a screen, a video call, a voice note, a recorded pitch. The rules shift slightly online. Look at the camera lens, not the faces, so you appear to make eye contact. Sit with light in front of you, not behind. Get close enough that your face fills a good part of the frame; distance reads as disengagement.

On calls, speak a touch slower and pause a beat longer, because there is lag and there are distractions. Start with your point immediately, online attention is short. And when you are not speaking, stay visibly present: nodding and looking engaged is part of communicating, even in silence.

Field Example: A freelancer doubled his client wins by fixing three things on calls: a window in front of him for light, the camera at eye level on a stack of books, and opening every call with 'Here is what I understood you need, did I get it right?' | Drill: Record a 45-second video pitch as if applying for a client or job. Check: eye-level camera, light on your face, point in the first five seconds. Redo until it feels natural.

4.2 Your CEO-level talk (Capstone)

Everything in this book comes together in one deliverable: a three-minute talk that could open a door for you. Choose a real goal, introduce your project, pitch a service, or make a case for change in your community. Build it on Point, Proof, Ask. Rehearse it out loud at least ten times, not in your head.

Rehearsal is where amateurs and professionals split. Record each run, watch it, fix one thing, run again. By the tenth pass you will stop thinking about words and start thinking about the person in front of you, which is the whole point. Then deliver it for real to someone who matters.

Competency Area	Capstone Standard	Starting	Target Mastery
1. Clarity & Preparation	Look at the lens to make eye contact.	Needs Draft	Confident & Ready
2. Execution Quality	Rehearse out loud and on camera, not in your head.	In Practice	Portfolio-Grade
3. Real-World Proof	Write and rehearse a 3-minute talk with a real audience in mind. Record ten takes, improving one thing each time. Deliver take eleven to a real person and ask for one piece of feedback.	Planned	Completed & Reviewed
4. Consistency Habit	A prepared three minutes can change your life.	Occasional	Weekly Discipline

5.1 Complete 8-Module Practice Matrix

Use this checklist to track every hands-on assignment in Communicate Like a CEO from Module 1 to your final project:

Module	Focus Topic	Core Deliverable & Principle
Module 01	Executive presence starts in your head	Presence is self-control made visible.
Module 02	Say less, mean more	Answer first, explain second.
Module 03	Body language and the power of the pause	First impressions are physical, not verbal.
Module 04	Structure any talk in three moves	Every message = Point, Proof, Ask.
Module 05	Persuade without pressure	Start from their goal, not your ask.
Module 06	Handle hard conversations and feedback	Soft on the person, hard on the problem.
Module 07	Own the camera and the online room	Look at the lens to make eye contact.
Module 08	Your CEO-level talk	Rehearse out loud and on camera, not in your head.

5.2 Applied Fellowship Reflections

"Before a big pitch, a founder I mentored used to shake. We changed one thing: three slow breaths and the sentence 'I am the most prepared person in this room.' Same slides, same voice, but investors started leaning in. Nothing changed except what she believed as she walked in."

CHRISCO Youth Aflame Cohort Case Note | Module 01





"One learner rehearsed her hub pitch eleven times on her phone. On the twelfth, live, she barely looked nervous. The listener's first words were, 'You have clearly done this before.' She hadn't. She had just practised properly."

CHRISCO Digital Academy Capstone Highlight | Module 08

06 90-Day Action Roadmap

True mastery in Communicate Like a CEO is measured by what you build, ship, and steward after finishing the lessons. Follow this structured 90-day implementation plan developed by CHRISCO Youth Aflame (under CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches) to turn study into fruitfulness.

6.1 Four-Stage Post-Course Milestones

01

Days 1 to 14: Foundation Sprint

Complete Modules 1 to 4 drills and document your baseline specimen in Communicate Like a CEO.

02

Days 15 to 30: First Live Output

Complete Modules 5 to 8 and ship your first real capstone deliverable: Write and rehearse a 3-minute talk with a real audience in mind. Record ten takes, improving one thing each time. Deliver take eleven to a real person and ask for one piece of feedback.

03

Days 31 to 60: Feedback & Iteration

Share your work with a mentor, peer, or real client/community audience and refine weak points.

04

Days 61 to 90: Service & Multiplication

Use your skill to serve your church, business, or clients faithfully and mentor one younger learner.

Follow-Up Stage	CHRISCO Support Channel	Contact & Cadence
Workbook Review	CHRISCO Digital Academy Desk	chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
Capstone Submission	CHRISCO Youth Aflame Mentors	shambetz@gmail.com
Peer Accountability	CHRISCO Fellowship Study Hubs	Monthly Cohort Check-In

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Equipping Youth, Elevating Purpose

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Under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

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Official Course E-Book for Communicate Like a CEO (Executive Leadership & Communication Track).
Prepared by CHRISCO Youth Aflame under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES.
For course guidance or mentorship, email chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com. CHRISCO Youth Aflame